

TidyTuesday Week 32

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Thursday 6th August, 2026

Contents

1	Weekly Summary	2
2	Date: 2026-08-03	4
2.1	Raw Regression	4
2.2	Detrended Regression	6
3	Date: 2026-08-04	8
3.1	Raw Regression	8
3.2	Detrended Regression	10
4	Date: 2026-08-05	12
4.1	Raw Regression	12
4.2	Detrended Regression	14
5	Date: 2026-08-06	16
5.1	Raw Regression	16
5.2	Detrended Regression	18

1 Weekly Summary

AI-Generated Content

The summary below was written by Claude (Anthropic) from that week's regression outputs and series descriptions. It has not been reviewed or fact-checked by a human, and should be read as an automated, informal recap – not analysis.

Welcome back to the only newsletter brave enough to shackle together economic data that has never met, never will meet, and frankly wants nothing to do with each other. This week the random-number gods really outdid themselves in pairing series that share nothing but the misfortune of living in the same database. As always, the house rules apply: everything you're about to read is a coincidence dressed up in a lab coat, and any conclusion you draw is legally your problem, not mine.

Monday kicked off with the headline act: Coinbase Bitcoin versus the San Francisco Tech Pulse, a tech-vibes index so discontinued it stopped observing reality in 2020. The raw regression clocked in at a swaggering R-squared of 0.70 with a p-value that has more zeros after the decimal than I have will to count them. "Bitcoin explains tech!" screamed the graph, before I remembered that both things went up over time, which is the statistical equivalent of noticing that two people standing on the same escalator are "rising together." And sure enough, detrend it and the R-squared face-plants down to 0.14. Now, mildly interesting: it's still technically significant after detrending (p around 0.003), so there's a faint, wobbly pulse of a real relationship here rather than pure escalator magic. I'm not going to build a hedge fund on it, but for this project that counts as a genuinely tantalizing morsel. Don't get excited. Okay, get a little excited. Then stop.

Tuesday and the rest of the week were where the dreams went to die, in the most soothing way possible. The Philadelphia Fed's capital-expenditures diffusion index against a real user cost index of some money aggregate produced an R-squared of 0.0006 and a p-value of 0.89, which is math's polite way of saying "these two have never once thought about each other." Wednesday paired Italy's central-bank foreign-exchange interventions from the 1990s with U.S. real-estate loan delinquency rates, and the raw regression flashed a "significant" p-value of 0.04 like it had something to tell us — until detrending mercilessly strangled it back to a p-value of 0.35. Textbook trend mirage; a shimmering oasis that turns to sand the moment you remove the shared drift. And Thursday's grand finale, a NAFTA recession on/off switch versus the U.S. current account balance, managed R-squared values of 0.005 raw and 0.0004 detrended, numbers so close to zero they should qualify for emotional support.

So the scoreboard for the week: one relationship that survived detrending with a heartbeat (Bitcoin and the ghost of San Francisco tech), and three that collapsed into the void the instant we asked them to prove they weren't just riding the same trend. This is, statistically speaking, a completely normal week for us — spurious correlation isn't the bug, it's the entire genre. None of this implies causation, none of it implies a real link, and if it did, the universe would owe us

an apology. Tune in next week when we let a random number generator ruin four more perfectly innocent time series.

2 Date: 2026-08-03

Series ID: CBBTCUSD

This series is titled Coinbase Bitcoin and has a frequency of Daily, 7-Day. The units are U.S. Dollars and the seasonal adjustment is Not Seasonally Adjusted. The observation start date is 2014-12-01 and the observation end date is 2026-08-02. The popularity of this series is 75.

Series ID: SFTPINDM114SFRBSF

This series is titled San Francisco Tech Pulse (DISCONTINUED) and has a frequency of Monthly. The units are Index Jan 2000=100 and the seasonal adjustment is Seasonally Adjusted. The observation start date is 1971-04-01 and the observation end date is 2020-03-01. The popularity of this series is 10.

2.1 Raw Regression

Regresses the two series against each other directly. A significant result here can come just as easily from both series sharing a long-run trend as from any real relationship.

Dep. Variable:	value_fred_SFTPINDM114SFRBSF	R-squared:	0.695
Model:	OLS	Adj. R-squared:	0.690
Method:	Least Squares	F-statistic:	139.1
Date:	Mon, 03 Aug 2026	Prob (F-statistic):	2.21e-17
Time:	14:09:51	Log-Likelihood:	-185.92
No. Observations:	63	AIC:	375.8
Df Residuals:	61	BIC:	380.1
Df Model:	1		
Covariance Type:	nonrobust		

	coef	std err	t	P> t	[0.025	0.975]
const	84.9060	0.863	98.348	0.000	83.180	86.632
value_fred_CBBTCUSD	0.0018	0.000	11.796	0.000	0.002	0.002

Omnibus:	9.975	Durbin-Watson:	0.305
Prob(Omnibus):	0.007	Jarque-Bera (JB):	10.825
Skew:	0.715	Prob(JB):	0.00446
Kurtosis:	4.442	Cond. No.	8.11e+03

Notes:

[1] Standard Errors assume that the covariance matrix of the errors is correctly specified.

[2] The condition number is large, 8.11e+03. This might indicate that there are strong multicollinearity or other numerical problems.

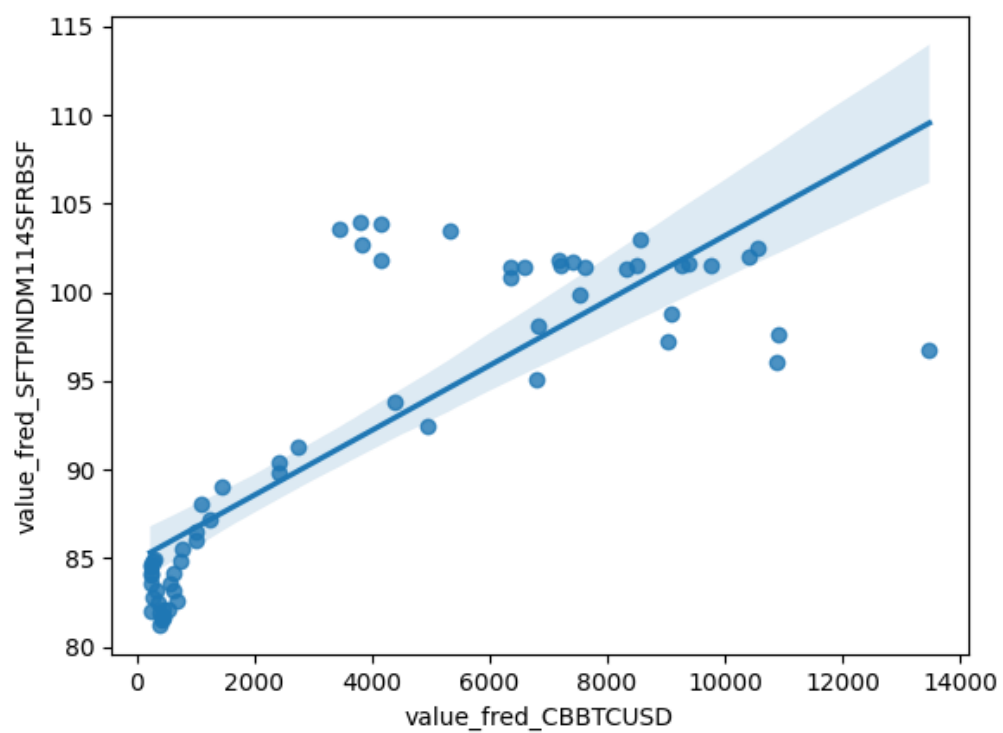


Figure 1: Raw Regression Plot for 2026-08-03

2.2 Detrended Regression

Regresses the residuals of each series after removing its own linear time trend, so a shared trend can no longer drive the result on its own. A relationship that stays significant here is better evidence of a genuine link between the two series.

Dep. Variable:	value_fred_SFTPINDM114SFRBSF_detrended	R-squared:	0.137
Model:	OLS	Adj. R-squared:	0.123
Method:	Least Squares	F-statistic:	9.672
Date:	Mon, 03 Aug 2026	Prob (F-statistic):	0.00284
Time:	14:09:51	Log-Likelihood:	-150.74
No. Observations:	63	AIC:	305.5
Df Residuals:	61	BIC:	309.8
Df Model:	1		
Covariance Type:	nonrobust		

	coef	std err	t	P> t	[0.025	0.975]
const	3.857e-12	0.339	1.14e-11	1.000	-0.678	0.678
value_fred_CBBTCUSD_detrended	0.0005	0.000	3.110	0.003	0.000	0.001

Omnibus:	23.048	Durbin-Watson:	0.095
Prob(Omnibus):	0.000	Jarque-Bera (JB):	4.918
Skew:	0.258	Prob(JB):	0.0855
Kurtosis:	1.732	Cond. No.	2.25e+03

Notes:

[1] Standard Errors assume that the covariance matrix of the errors is correctly specified.

[2] The condition number is large, 2.25e+03. This might indicate that there are strong multicollinearity or other numerical problems.

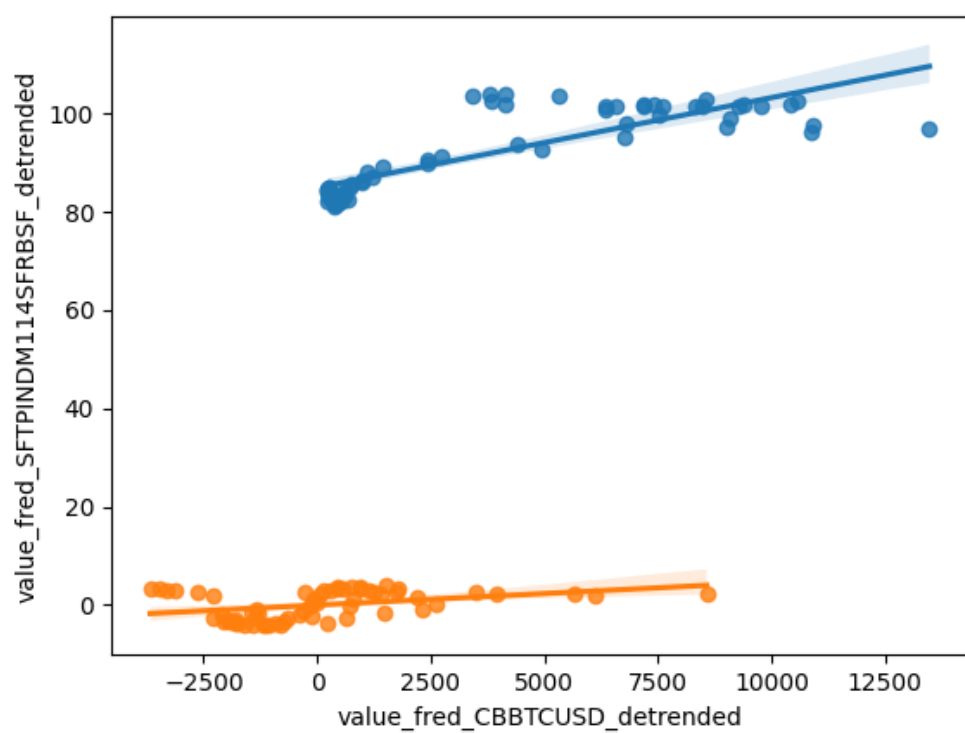


Figure 2: Detrended Regression Plot for 2026-08-03

3 Date: 2026-08-04

Series ID: CPBNDIF066MSFRBPHI

This series is titled Current Physical Plant Capital Expenditures; Diffusion Index for Federal Reserve District 3: Philadelphia and has a frequency of Monthly. The units are Index and the seasonal adjustment is Seasonally Adjusted. The observation start date is 2011-03-01 and the observation end date is 2026-07-01. The popularity of this series is 1.

Series ID: OCM2MP

This series is titled Real User Cost Index of MSI-M2M (preferred) and has a frequency of Monthly. The units are Percent and the seasonal adjustment is Not Seasonally Adjusted. The observation start date is 1967-01-01 and the observation end date is 2013-12-01. The popularity of this series is 4.

3.1 Raw Regression

Regresses the two series against each other directly. A significant result here can come just as easily from both series sharing a long-run trend as from any real relationship.

Dep. Variable:	value_fred_OCM2MP	R-squared:	0.001
Model:	OLS	Adj. R-squared:	-0.031
Method:	Least Squares	F-statistic:	0.01870
Date:	Tue, 04 Aug 2026	Prob (F-statistic):	0.892
Time:	13:31:41	Log-Likelihood:	184.86
No. Observations:	34	AIC:	-365.7
Df Residuals:	32	BIC:	-362.7
Df Model:	1		
Covariance Type:	nonrobust		

	coef	std err	t	P> t 	[0.025	0.975]
const	0.0155	0.000	36.337	0.000	0.015	0.016
value_fred_CPBNDIF066MSFRBPHI	3.385e-06	2.47e-05	0.137	0.892	-4.7e-05	5.38e-05

Omnibus:	9.983	Durbin-Watson:	0.076
Prob(Omnibus):	0.007	Jarque-Bera (JB):	2.548
Skew:	0.142	Prob(JB):	0.280
Kurtosis:	1.689	Cond. No.	39.7

Notes:

[1] Standard Errors assume that the covariance matrix of the errors is correctly specified.

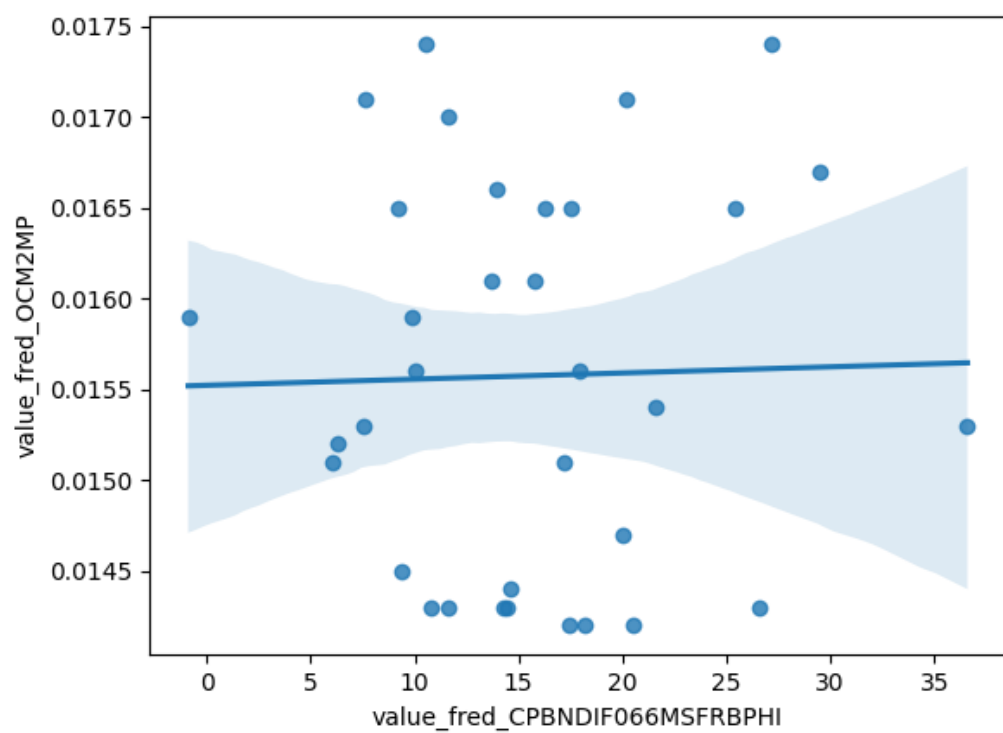


Figure 3: Raw Regression Plot for 2026-08-04

3.2 Detrended Regression

Regresses the residuals of each series after removing its own linear time trend, so a shared trend can no longer drive the result on its own. A relationship that stays significant here is better evidence of a genuine link between the two series.

Dep. Variable:	value_fred_OCM2MP_detrended	R-squared:	0.000
Model:	OLS	Adj. R-squared:	-0.031
Method:	Least Squares	F-statistic:	0.006047
Date:	Tue, 04 Aug 2026	Prob (F-statistic):	0.939
Time:	13:31:41	Log-Likelihood:	193.17
No. Observations:	34	AIC:	-382.3
Df Residuals:	32	BIC:	-379.3
Df Model:	1		
Covariance Type:	nonrobust		

	coef	std err	t	P> t	[0.025	0.975]
const	4.858e-15	0.000	3.33e-11	1.000	-0.000	0.000
value_fred_CPBNDIF066MSFRBPHI_detrended	1.508e-06	1.94e-05	0.078	0.939	-3.8e-05	4.1e-05

Omnibus:	10.150	Durbin-Watson:	0.122
Prob(Omnibus):	0.006	Jarque-Bera (JB):	2.467
Skew:	0.016	Prob(JB):	0.291
Kurtosis:	1.681	Cond. No.	7.52

Notes:

[1] Standard Errors assume that the covariance matrix of the errors is correctly specified.

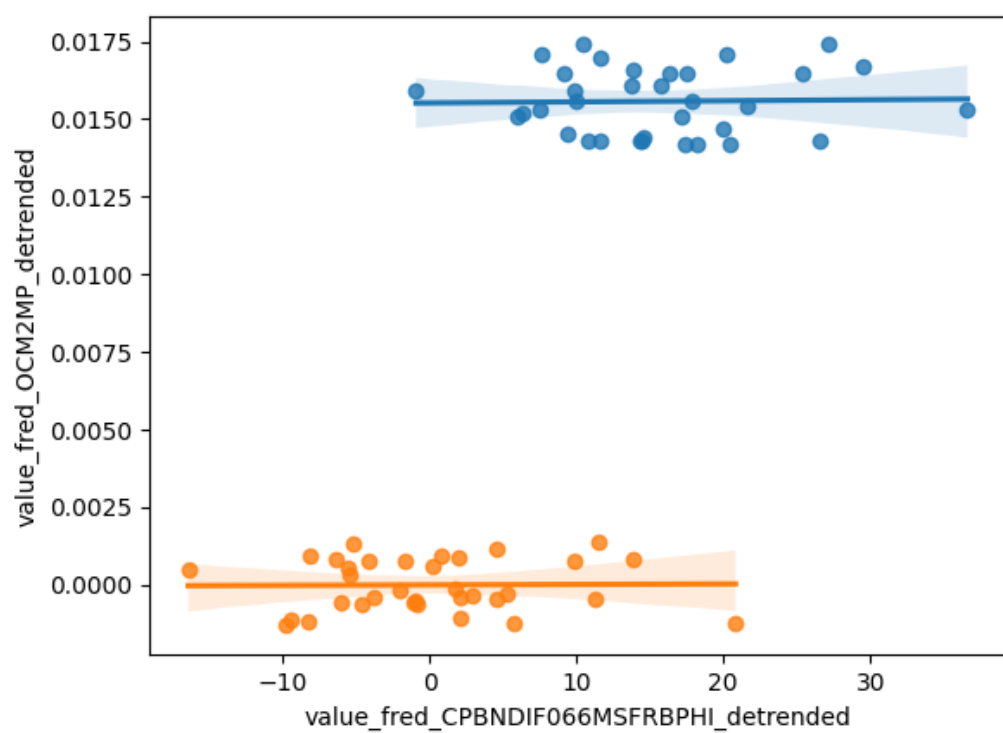


Figure 4: Detrended Regression Plot for 2026-08-04

4 Date: 2026-08-05

Series ID: ITINTDRES

This series is titled Italian Intervention: Banca d'Italia Purchases of Foreign Exchange (Millions of ECU's, Euros after 1999) (DISCONTINUED) and has a frequency of Daily, 7-Day. The units are Millions of ECU's, Euros after 1999 and the seasonal adjustment is Not Seasonally Adjusted. The observation start date is 1988-01-01 and the observation end date is 1998-12-31. The popularity of this series is 2.

Series ID: DRSRET100N

This series is titled Delinquency Rate on Loans Secured by Real Estate, Banks Ranked 1st to 100th Largest in Size by Assets and has a frequency of Quarterly, End of Period. The units are Percent and the seasonal adjustment is Not Seasonally Adjusted. The observation start date is 1987-01-01 and the observation end date is 2026-01-01. The popularity of this series is 1.

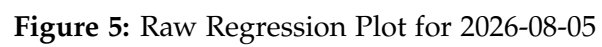
4.1 Raw Regression

Regresses the two series against each other directly. A significant result here can come just as easily from both series sharing a long-run trend as from any real relationship.

Dep. Variable:	value_fred_DRSRET100N	R-squared:	0.095			
Model:	OLS	Adj. R-squared:	0.074			
Method:	Least Squares	F-statistic:	4.433			
Date:	Wed, 05 Aug 2026	Prob (F-statistic):	0.0413			
Time:	13:32:37	Log-Likelihood:	-100.49			
No. Observations:	44	AIC:	205.0			
Df Residuals:	42	BIC:	208.5			
Df Model:	1					
Covariance Type:	nonrobust					
	coef	std err	t	P> t	[0.025	0.975]
const	5.6231	0.377	14.905	0.000	4.862	6.384
value_fred_ITINTDRES	-0.0081	0.004	-2.105	0.041	-0.016	-0.000
Omnibus:	5.847	Durbin-Watson:	0.227			
Prob(Omnibus):	0.054	Jarque-Bera (JB):	2.476			
Skew:	0.255	Prob(JB):	0.290			
Kurtosis:	1.956	Cond. No.	101.			

Notes:

[1] Standard Errors assume that the covariance matrix of the errors is correctly specified.



4.2 Detrended Regression

Regresses the residuals of each series after removing its own linear time trend, so a shared trend can no longer drive the result on its own. A relationship that stays significant here is better evidence of a genuine link between the two series.

Dep. Variable:	value_fred_DRSRET100N_detrended	R-squared:	0.021
Model:	OLS	Adj. R-squared:	-0.002
Method:	Least Squares	F-statistic:	0.9112
Date:	Wed, 05 Aug 2026	Prob (F-statistic):	0.345
Time:	13:32:38	Log-Likelihood:	-87.537
No. Observations:	44	AIC:	179.1
Df Residuals:	42	BIC:	182.6
Df Model:	1		
Covariance Type:	nonrobust		

	coef	std err	t	P> t	[0.025	0.975]
const	-5.314e-13	0.273	-1.95e-12	1.000	-0.551	0.551
value_fred_ITINTDRES_detrended	-0.0029	0.003	-0.955	0.345	-0.009	0.003

Omnibus:	3.670	Durbin-Watson:	0.127
Prob(Omnibus):	0.160	Jarque-Bera (JB):	3.038
Skew:	0.532	Prob(JB):	0.219
Kurtosis:	2.275	Cond. No.	90.8

Notes:

[1] Standard Errors assume that the covariance matrix of the errors is correctly specified.

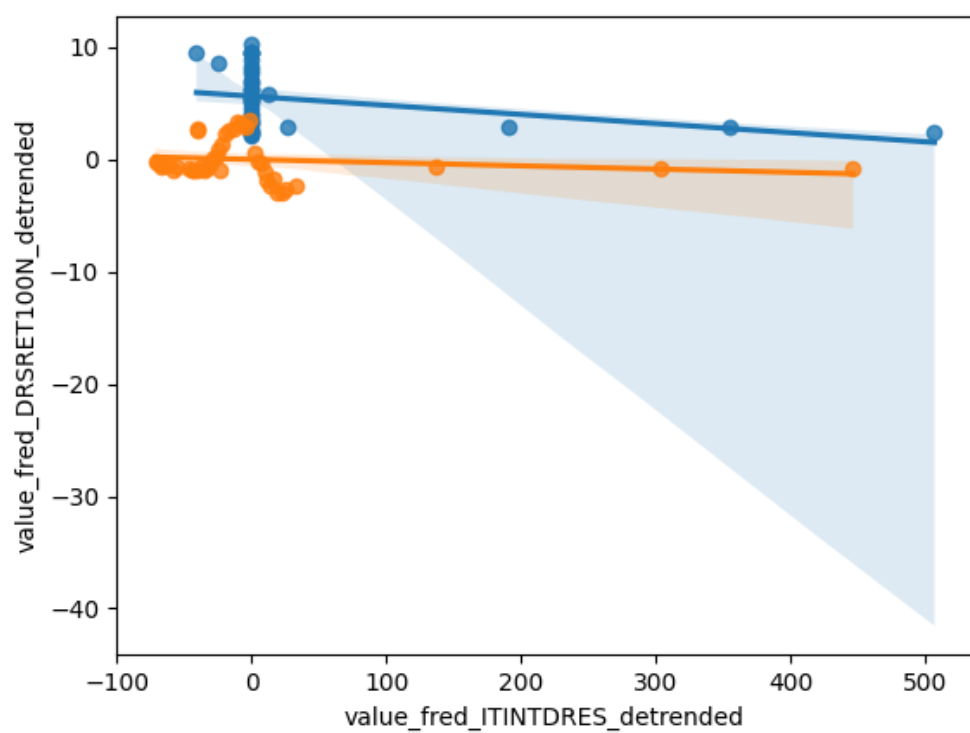


Figure 6: Detrended Regression Plot for 2026-08-05

5 Date: 2026-08-06

Series ID: NAFTARECP

This series is titled OECD based Recession Indicators for NAFTA Area from the Peak through the Period preceding the Trough (DISCONTINUED) and has a frequency of Monthly. The units are +1 or 0 and the seasonal adjustment is Not Seasonally Adjusted. The observation start date is 1947-03-01 and the observation end date is 2022-08-01. The popularity of this series is 1.

Series ID: BOPBCAA

This series is titled Balance on Current Account (DISCONTINUED) and has a frequency of Annual. The units are Billions of Dollars and the seasonal adjustment is Not Seasonally Adjusted. The observation start date is 1960-01-01 and the observation end date is 2013-01-01. The popularity of this series is 6.

5.1 Raw Regression

Regresses the two series against each other directly. A significant result here can come just as easily from both series sharing a long-run trend as from any real relationship.

Dep. Variable:	value_fred_BOPBCAA	R-squared:	0.005			
Model:	OLS	Adj. R-squared:	-0.014			
Method:	Least Squares	F-statistic:	0.2814			
Date:	Thu, 06 Aug 2026	Prob (F-statistic):	0.598			
Time:	13:27:58	Log-Likelihood:	-371.18			
No. Observations:	54	AIC:	746.4			
Df Residuals:	52	BIC:	750.3			
Df Model:	1					
Covariance Type:	nonrobust					
	coef	std err	t	P> t	[0.025	0.975]
const	-188.9963	40.873	-4.624	0.000	-271.014	-106.979
value_fred_NAFTARECP	35.6291	67.161	0.531	0.598	-99.139	170.398
Omnibus:	12.191	Durbin-Watson:	0.065			
Prob(Omnibus):	0.002	Jarque-Bera (JB):	13.569			
Skew:	-1.223	Prob(JB):	0.00113			
Kurtosis:	3.210	Cond. No.	2.43			

Notes:

[1] Standard Errors assume that the covariance matrix of the errors is correctly specified.

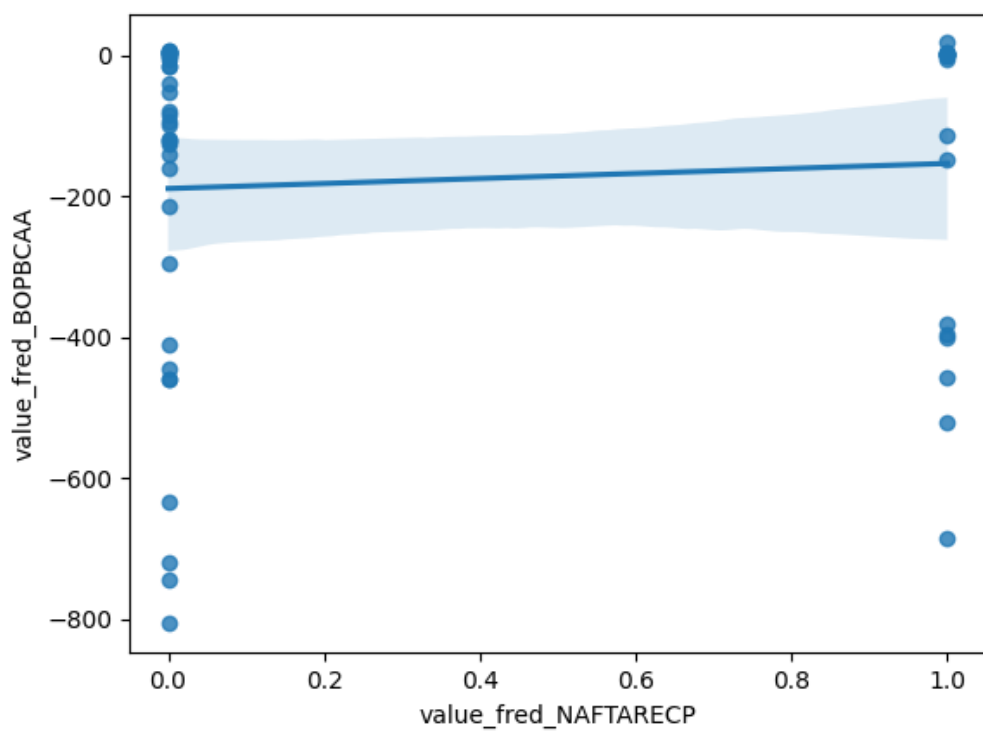


Figure 7: Raw Regression Plot for 2026-08-06

5.2 Detrended Regression

Regresses the residuals of each series after removing its own linear time trend, so a shared trend can no longer drive the result on its own. A relationship that stays significant here is better evidence of a genuine link between the two series.

Dep. Variable:	value_fred_BOPBCAA_detrended	R-squared:	0.000
Model:	OLS	Adj. R-squared:	-0.019
Method:	Least Squares	F-statistic:	0.02165
Date:	Thu, 06 Aug 2026	Prob (F-statistic):	0.884
Time:	13:27:58	Log-Likelihood:	-340.93
No. Observations:	54	AIC:	685.9
Df Residuals:	52	BIC:	689.8
Df Model:	1		
Covariance Type:	nonrobust		

	coef	std err	t	P> t	[0.025	0.975]
const	7.162e-12	18.522	3.87e-13	1.000	-37.167	37.167
value_fred_NAFTARECP_detrended	-5.6739	38.562	-0.147	0.884	-83.055	71.707

Omnibus:	8.580	Durbin-Watson:	0.207
Prob(Omnibus):	0.014	Jarque-Bera (JB):	7.858
Skew:	-0.877	Prob(JB):	0.0197
Kurtosis:	3.646	Cond. No.	2.08

Notes:

[1] Standard Errors assume that the covariance matrix of the errors is correctly specified.

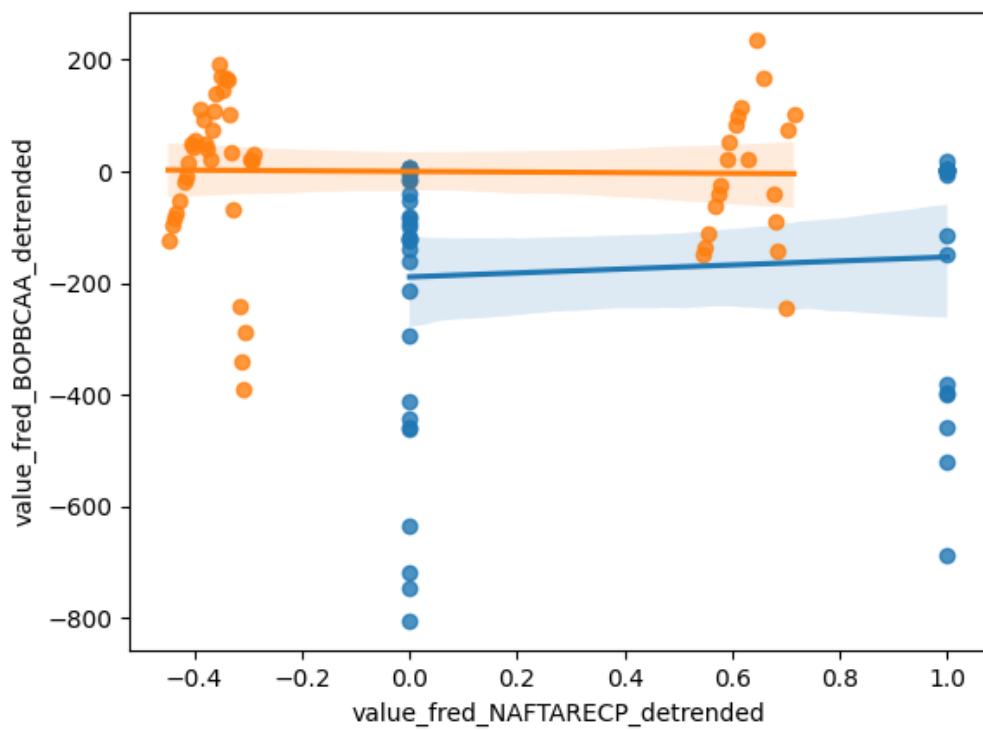


Figure 8: Detrended Regression Plot for 2026-08-06